34. Fertile soils, therefore, extend over only about ten percent of the surface of South America. The most important of these are brunizems, chestnut soils, and ferruginous tropical soils. The Argentine Pampas, the largest fertile area on the continent, is uniformly covered with the so-called pampean loess, which is calcareous, rich in minerals, and mixed with volcanic sediment.
35. South America has two major mountain systems of contrasting nature. Bordering the Pacific Ocean to the west, the geologically young cordilleras of the Andes extend along the entire continent from north to south. Stretching along the continent's northern and eastern sides are the ancient Guiana and Brazilian highlands, which are much lower in elevation and slope gently to the west; farther south are the Patagonian plateaus. Lowlands-the basins of the Orinoco, Amazon, and Paraguay-Paraná rivers and the plains of the Pampasseparate the highlands from one another. Taken as a whole, the relief of the continent shows a great imbalance: the major drainage divide is far to the west along the crest of the Andes. Thus, rain that falls only 100 miles (160 kilometres) east of the Pacific may flow to the Atlantic, 2500 miles away.
36. **Brazil current**
    - In the South Atlantic Ocean, the south equatorial current, flowing from east to west, splits into two branches near Cape de Sao Roque (Brazil).
    - The northern branch joins the north equatorial current (a part of it flows in Anatilles Current and other into Gulf of Mexico), whereas the southern branch turns southward and flows along the South American coast as the warm Brazil current.
    - The south flowing Brazil current swings eastward at about latitude 35°S (due to westerlies) to join the West Wind Drift flowing from west to east.
    - A small branch of West Wind Drift splits and flows between Argentinian coast and Falkland Islands and this current is called as Falkland cold current.
    - It mixes with warm Brazil current at the southern tip of Brazil.
37. As El Niño's warm pool feeds thunderstorms above, it creates increased rainfall across the east-central and eastern Pacific Ocean, including several portions of the South American west